

Innovation Insight

Purpose

Client Utility - Get Foresight

An Innovation Insight is designed to provide clients with specific actionable insights on a clearly defined innovation, including its benefits, uses and inherent risks. Innovations are often early-life-cycle areas of interest to our clients.

A single Innovation Insight can refer to multiple innovations provided they are strongly linked and can be grouped under a single defining characteristic or capability.

What You Need to Know

An Innovation Insight delivers detailed, actionable insights on the benefits, applications, and risks of emerging innovations, processes, practices, and trends.

Selecting an innovation: An innovation can be (but isn't necessarily limited to):

- A new technology or new use of existing technologies
- A product or service
- A business practice (a capability)
- The Nascent or Emerging stage of a market (also known as a "proto-market")
- Mandatory approval is required for this content type by the ITLTP Group CoR and Role CoR. Approvals should be requested (via email) prior to starting the piece, then documented in a comment in the CPP Google Doc item, tagging the approver in the comment.
- Within each piece, the innovation definition must discretely be approved by the KI leader and Role CoR as peer reviewers. If you are expanding on an Innovation Profile in a Hype Cycle, the definitions should match.

[Document Update History](#) summarizes recent changes in this document.

KEY INFORMATION

Research Model:

A&E

Alternatives:

[Trends Explorer](#), [Market Guide \(Basic, Detailed\)](#), [Top Practices](#)

Contextualization Options:

[Perspective](#), [Variant](#), [Base Content \(Formerly Concept\)](#)

BTI Studio Support:

[Launchpad](#)
[Publishing 2.0 Resources](#)

Good Examples:

[Innovation Insight for the AI Agent Platform Landscape](#)

[Innovation Insight: Model Context Protocol](#)

Lifecycle:

[Content Type Life Cycle](#)
[Management Options](#)

External Review:

N/A

For Help:

[AskMethodologies](#)
[Content Help Center](#)

9-Min Read Time Warning

(CPP): Yes

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How to Write, Structure and Style an Innovation Insight

The Section Heading column specifies whether each section is required or optional and indicates whether or not the heading in the CPP canvas will publish on g.com.

Section Heading	How to Write, Structure and Style It
Title Required <i>Header won't publish</i>	- Recommended title format: Prefix: "Innovation Insight." Post-prefix: Include the "what" (the innovation). We recommend also including the "why" (the main capability of the innovation - what it will help clients do) Example: <i>Innovation Insight: Digital Health Platforms Allow Rapid Change Response</i> Ideal Length: 20 to 65 characters (including spaces)
Summary Required <i>Header won't publish</i>	- In 2-3 sentences, convey the specific challenge, opportunity or situation that your research addresses. Then, outline how this research will help the approved target role. Length: No more than 300 characters (including spaces). HARD LIMIT
Executive Summary Required <i>Header publishes as "Overview"</i>	Executive Summary helps clients quickly understand the note's relevance. - This section consists of two subsections: Key Findings, Recommendation(s). Ideal Length: Maximum 300 words Key Findings: - Include a bulleted list of 2-4 crucial and actionable insights for the reader found in this research Recommendation(s): - Be specific and action-oriented. Avoid platitudes. - Relate the findings and recommendations to the end-user client. What is challenging about making decisions in this market? What actions should end users take given the dynamics of the market, and benefits and risks it poses? - Support with data, facts, and examples. Ideal Length: Limit to 4 bullet points.
Strategic Planning Assumption(s) Optional	- If your research team uses SPAs, include any that are relevant in this section. - Remove this section from the canvas if not needed.
Introduction Required	Encourage the targeted role to delve deeper into the innovation by succinctly presenting the context, problem, or opportunity it addresses.

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	- At least one graphic (figure or table) is required, and it is recommended to add a figure in the Introduction to draw readers into the research. Ideal Length: Up to 120 words
Description Required <i>Included in the G.com ToC experience.</i>	Definition Begin with a universal definition of the innovation, independent of the target role. Describe what the technology, product, or practice accomplishes. - When analyzing multiple related innovations or presenting proto-market coverage, ensure you provide a single definition that highlights the defining characteristic or capability. - If there is a corresponding Hype Cycle Innovation Profile, Impact Radar profile or Trends Explorer profile, the definition used here must match the definition/description in that profile. Format: Add the definition in a Feature Call-Out: Text Only component, with the title "Definition". This makes it stand apart from the extra description. Ideal Length: Up to 100 words Extra Description You may extend the universal definition with extra description, which can be geared to your target role. - As required, describe component parts, enabling technologies, related concepts and/or more complex detail about the innovation. Ideal Length: Up to 300 words
Benefits and Uses Required <i>Included in the G.com ToC experience.</i>	Write an analysis about the benefits of the innovation and how it can be used. Try to incorporate all or at least most of the following: - Why do clients need to pay attention to it? - How might it help or affect the business? - Where could it be (or is it being) applied? - What industries could use it? - What enterprises are using this innovation now? Use a case in point to outline examples, if relevant. Ideal Length: Up to 1,000 words (up to 3 pages in CPP, including graphics)
Risks Required <i>Included in the G.com ToC experience.</i>	Explain any drawbacks, risks, pitfalls and/or nonoptimal implementations of the innovation. - How will it affect clients' IT environment or processes? Identify possible integration issues. - What could happen if it is not used well or correctly? - What actions should clients take now, and in the future, to mitigate risks? - Discuss the cautions to heed or risks to mitigate, as well as which areas or industries face the most risk. Ideal Length: Up to 500 words (1-2 pages in CPP)

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Adoption Rate Optional	Detail how widespread the use of the innovation is, as well as the factors driving or hindering its adoption. Remove the section from canvas if not needed. • Include industry / org. size / regional trends as appropriate. • If discussing the innovation in the context of a proto-market, include commentary on the trajectory and future growth potential of this space. Is it likely to succeed or fail? What are the influencing factors? • If there is a corresponding Hype Cycle Innovation Profile or Impact Radar profile, adoption commentary here should be aligned to the profile's placement in the corresponding document. • Ideal Length: Up to 300 words
Alternatives Optional	What other technologies, practices or processes can be used to accomplish the same things? Briefly summarize the alternatives and provide links to other research that goes more in-depth. • Suggest using a bulleted list. • Ideal Length: Up to 200 words
Recommendations Required <i>Included in the G.com ToC experience.</i>	This is your opportunity to expand on the 1-4 actionable recommendations you provided in the Executive Summary. Embellish your recommendations to provide more detail or fact base around why each is the right step for readers to take. • If you do not need to embellish your initial recommendations, simply repeat them verbatim. This will avoid reader confusion as to how they may differ. • Style: Bullets • Ideal Length: Up to 200 words
Representative Providers Optional <i>Included in the G.com ToC experience.</i>	List up to 10 providers that are important to this innovation. Do not characterize, profile or describe vendor offerings. Remove the section from canvas if not needed. • Include vendor name and, optionally, product names as well. Avoid adding version information as this can quickly date research. • Style: Bullets
Evidence Required	• Provide the factual basis for your analysis.
Contributors Optional	Use this space to acknowledge associates who provide meaningful input, advice and/or raw material in the creation of research content but who are not co-authors/co-creators. • Recognize associates who contributed but are not co-authors. • Format: first name + last name; list alphabetically by last name, separated by commas. Only include names, no additional details or team names. HARD RULE • Ensure correct spelling; no nicknames.
Acronym Key and Glossary Terms	• Include market and technology definitions, if needed.

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Optional	
Notes Optional	• Use notes to add non-essential detail or context. Remove the section from canvas if not needed. • Replace the text “Notes” with this format: “Note X: [Title]”.

Multimedia/Components

For full guidance on how to use graphics and components, see the [Consumability Playbook](#).

Graphics	Must include at least one graphic. Add graphics as needed to visualize detailed evidence or illustrate an important, complex or novel concept (per Principle 5 of the Consumability Playbook. • Use resources via the Launchpad if required. • See Adding Graphics in CPP for guidance on how to add or reuse figures.
Video/Audio	Use of the audio or video component is not permitted for this content type at this time. Contact Methodologies to seek approval if you believe you have identified an urgent use case.
Downloads	Downloads are not permitted for this content type at this time. Contact Methodologies to seek approval if you believe you have identified an urgent use case.
Case in Point	Permitted for this content type: • From the Sections panel, add a “Feature Call-out - Case in Point” component in the Analysis section (choose the “Image with Wrap” version if including a company logo; “Text Only” if not) • Header text: “Case in Point: [Topic] ([Company Name])” • For more details, see the Case in Point guidelines. Note: Use of a Case in Point component will produce boilerplate disclaimer text towards the bottom of your published piece on gartner.com: <i>The organization (or organizations) profiled in this research is (or are) provided for illustrative purposes only, and does (or do) not constitute an exhaustive list of examples in this field nor an endorsement by Gartner of the organization or its offerings.</i>

Instructions to Authors

Coverage Evolution - Selecting the Appropriate Content Type

- **Trigger** - A new technology, product, service, capability or market goes through a very early embryonic stage. One primary source of initial Gartner coverage of an innovation is a “dot” (Innovation Profile) on a Hype Cycle. Other sources could be Impact Radars (HTI only) or technology profiles in a Trends Explorer.
- **Insight** - The next step is to expand on the initial coverage by providing additional insight and explanation using an Innovation Insight.
- **Progression** - Once the technology, product, service, capability or market shifts from nascent to emerging, the analyst should now utilize one of the following doc types [methodology to provide guidance here].

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- **Mature Innovations** - A secondary use of Innovation Insight is to provide foundational research on a mature technology, product or practice that clients may need to level-set on, to confirm or correct assumptions. Mature innovations would correspond to the Plateau or Sunsetting stages of a market lifecycle.

Appendix: Incorporating Case in Point

Case content is a proven practical, real-world application of a technology, process or initiative by a single named or anonymous company to solve their own internal business problem.

Clients consume case content in two ways: as a case study and as a Case in Point. A Case in Point is:

- **A short, real-world example to support a broader teaching**, obtained from either:
 - A full written case study, summarized for a different context, or
 - Secondary, reputable sources
- **A component of a larger research note or library**. Unlike a full case study, it does not stand alone in the client experience.

Cases in Point do not have a defined structure. They are components inserted into non-case-study content types, such as Top Practices or Impact Appraisals.

For more details, see the [Case in Point guidelines](#).

Additional Resources

Resource	Description
Content Essentials	Content Essentials is a set of seven criteria identified through client feedback that support quality content and strengthen client retention.
How to Write Good Titles, Summaries and Executive Summaries How to Write a Great Summary	Detailed instructions on how to write good titles, summaries, and executive summaries.
Contextualization Availability by Content Type	Details the contextualization options available for each content type
Content Type Life Cycle Management Options	Details the lifecycle management options(default, extendable, evergreen, etc.) for all content types
How to Create Actionable Recommendations	This collateral provides a comprehensive guide on crafting actionable recommendations

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The Art of Writing Good SPAs/Predictions	This collateral provides a comprehensive guide on crafting good SPAs/Predictions
External Review Policy	This policy outlines general guidelines for when external review is required.
Gartner's Research Contribution & Attribution Guidelines	This document defines the Gartner associate roles involved in content creation and outlines their attribution on Gartner.com.
Content Help Center	Provided tips, tools and best practices for planning content before you begin.
AskMethodologies	AskMethodologies is a knowledge base that covers topics such as contextualization, policies and content lifecycle management, and it's the first place associates should go with any Methodologies-related questions.
Launchpad	Links to the Launchpad

Instructions to Editors

- TOC experience is enabled for this content type. The headings that will appear are:
 - [Description](#)
 - [Benefits and Uses](#)
 - [Risks](#)
 - [Recommendations](#)
 - [Representative Providers](#)

Document Update History

Month of Update	Notable Changes
December 2025	• Minor updates to reflect change from R&A to BTI • Examples refreshed
Nov 2024	The Recommended Reading section has been moved from the canvas into an Add-On panel. See this page and this user guide for reference.
August 2023	Removed KI lead in requirement for Recommendations section. The Key Facts Sidebar has been edited to remove the practices and any superfluous text, and to add links to the Content Type Life Cycle Management Options and the Content Help Center. Added market-based information based on revamp market coverage.
April 2023	Added new, optional Contributors section.

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May 2022	Updated Case in Point guidance; stipulated use of component for innovation definition
Sep 2021	Perspective and Variant contextualization options added
May 2021	Added case in point disclaimer guidance
Oct 2020	Consolidated Innovation Tech Insight and Emerging Tech Analysis guidance; removed references to Market Clock
Jun 2020	Contextualization options added